Mr. Wei's Chinese Class

Expanded HSK 1 Master Plan (Lessons 1-13) for Khaopan

Welcome to your upgraded Chinese curriculum, Khaopan! This expanded textbook goes beyond simple rules. Every lesson now includes the "Why" behind the grammar, varied examples, and guided walkthroughs to build deep, long-term comprehension before you test your skills in the workbooks. Let's begin compiling!

Phase 1: The Pronunciation Engine

Lesson 1: Pinyin and The Four Tones

The Concept (The "Why")

Chinese characters do not give you phonetic clues on how to pronounce them. To solve this, we use **Pinyin**, a system that uses the English alphabet to represent Chinese sounds. Furthermore, Chinese is a *tonal* language. The exact same syllable can mean "Mother" or "Horse" purely based on the pitch of your voice.

Varied Examples

Tone	Mark	Pitch Movement	Meaning Example (ma)
1st	mā	High and flat (like singing)	妈 (Mother)
2nd	má	Rising (like asking "Huh?")	麻 (Hemp)
3rd	mǎ	Dipping down then up	马 (Horse)
4th	mà	Falling sharply (command)	骂 (Scold)

Guided Walkthrough

Try saying the English word "What".
1. If you say it in surprise ("What?!"), your voice goes up. That is the **2nd Tone**.
2. If you say it angrily ("What!"), your voice drops hard. That is the **4th Tone**.

Workbook 1: Tones & Pinyin

1. What is the starting consonant of a Pinyin syllable called?
2. Which tone is high and flat?
3. Which tone dips down and then goes up?
4. True or False: "mā" and "mà" mean the exact same thing.
5. What is the Pinyin mark for the 2nd tone on the letter 'a'?
6. If you are giving a sharp command, which tone does it sound like?
7. Identify the 'final' (vowel part) in the pinyin syllable "hao".
8. What is the Pinyin system used for?

Answers:

1. Initial | 2. 1st Tone | 3. 3rd Tone | 4. False
5. á | 6. 4th Tone | 7. ao | 8. To read the sounds of Chinese characters

Lesson 2: Greetings and Numbers

The Concept (The "Why")

In Chinese, the standard greeting **你好** (nǐ hǎo) literally translates to "You Good". Chinese culture values directness and numeric logic. The number system is so logical that once you learn 1 through 10, you can easily count up to 99 just by combining them.

Varied Examples

- **Hello:** **你好** (*nǐ hǎo*)
- **Thank you:** **谢谢** (*xiè xie*)
- **Goodbye:** **再见** (*zài jiàn* - literally "Again see")
- **Numbers 1-5:** **一, 二, 三, 四, 五** (*yī, èr, sān, sì, wǔ*)
- **Numbers 6-10:** **六, 七, 八, 九, 十** (*liù, qī, bā, jiǔ, shí*)

Guided Walkthrough

How do we say 11? In Chinese, 11 is just "Ten One": 十一 (*shí yī*).

How about 20? It's just "Two Tens": 二十 (*èr shí*).

Using this logic, 23 is "Two Tens Three": 二十三 (*èr shí sān*).

Workbook 2: First Words

1. Translate to English: *nǐ hǎo*
2. Translate to English: *xiè xie*
3. How do you say "Goodbye" in Pinyin?
4. Match the number: 一 (A. 2, B. 1, C. 3)
5. Match the number: *wǔ* (A. 4, B. 5, C. 6)
6. Match the number: 十 (A. 8, B. 9, C. 10)
7. Using the logic above, write the Pinyin for the number 12.
8. Translate to Pinyin: 3, 2, 1.

Answers:

1. Hello | 2. Thank you | 3. zài jiàn | 4. B (1)
5. B (5) | 6. C (10) | 7. shí èr | 8. sān, èr, yī

Phase 2: Core HSK 1 Grammar (S-V-O Structure)

Lesson 3: The "To Be" Verb & Pronouns

The Concept (The "Why")

Chinese sentence structure matches English: **Subject + Verb + Object**. However, Chinese is much easier because verbs **never conjugate**. The verb "to be" is always **是** (*shì*), whether you are saying "I am", "You are", or "He is".

Varied Examples

- **我** (*wǒ*) = I / Me
- **你** (*nǐ*) = You
- **他 / 她** (*tā*) = He / She (Notice they have the exact same Pinyin!)
- **学生** (*xué sheng*) = Student
- **老师** (*lǎo shī*) = Teacher

Guided Walkthrough

Let's introduce people.

I am a student: **我** (I) + **是** (am) + **学生** (student) = **我是学生。**

She is a teacher: **她** (She) + **是** (is) + **老师** (teacher) = **她是老师。**

Workbook 3: Identity

1. What does **我** (*wǒ*) mean?
2. Translate to Chinese characters: "You"
3. True or False: "He" and "She" sound identical in spoken Chinese.
4. What is the verb for "Am/Is/Are"?
5. Translate to Pinyin: "I am a student."
6. Translate to English: **他是学生。** (*tā shì xué sheng.*)
7. Sentence Scramble: **学生 / 你 / 是** (Rearrange to "You are a student")
8. Fill in the blank: *wǒ* ___ *Khaopan.* (I am Khaopan).

Answers:

1. I / Me | 2. 你 | 3. True | 4. 是 (shì)
5. wǒ shì xué sheng. | 6. He is a student. | 7. 你是学生。 | 8. shì (是)

Lesson 4: Action Verbs and Objects

The Concept (The "Why")

Just like the verb "to be", action verbs never change form. Whether you eat today, ate yesterday, or will eat tomorrow, the word **吃** (*chī*) stays exactly the same. Context and time words tell us when it happened.

Varied Examples

Action Verbs	Nouns (Objects)
吃 (*chī*) - to eat	**苹果** (*píng guǒ*) - apple
喝 (*hē*) - to drink	**水** (*shuǐ*) - water
看 (*kàn*) - to look/watch/read	**书** (*shū*) - book

Guided Walkthrough

Let's build basic action sequences:

I eat an apple: **我** (I) + **吃** (eat) + **苹果** (apple) = **我吃苹果。**

He reads a book: **他** (He) + **看** (look/read) + **书** (book) = **他看书。**

Workbook 4: Actions

1. Translate to English: **我喝水。** (*wǒ hē shuǐ.*)
2. Translate to English: **你看书。** (*nǐ kàn shū.*)
3. What is the Chinese character for "eat"?
4. What is the Pinyin for "apple"?
5. Sentence Scramble: **水** / **喝** / **他** (Rearrange to "He drinks water")
6. Translate to Pinyin: "I read a book."
7. Match the noun: *shuǐ* (A. Book, B. Water, C. Apple)
8. Translate to Chinese characters: I eat an apple.

Answers:

1. I drink water. | 2. You read a book. | 3. 吃 | 4. píng guǒ
5. 他喝水。 | 6. wǒ kàn shū. | 7. B (Water) | 8. 我吃苹果。

Lesson 5: Asking Questions (吗 & 什么)

The Concept (The "Why")

In Chinese, you do not need to rearrange the sentence structure to ask a question. The Subject-Verb-Object blueprint stays exactly the same. You simply use specific "question particles" as flags to change the function of the sentence.

Varied Examples

- **The Boolean Flag (吗):** Add **吗** (*ma*) to the end of any statement to make it a Yes/No question.
  - **你是学生。** (You are a student.) ➔ **你是学生吗？** (Are you a student?)
  - **他喝水。** (He drinks water.) ➔ **他喝水吗？** (Does he drink water?)

- **The Placeholder (什么):** Instead of moving "What" to the front of the sentence (like in English), Chinese leaves **什么** (*shén me*) exactly where the unknown object belongs.
  - **你吃什么？** (You eat WHAT?) = What do you eat?
  - **他看什么？** (He looks at WHAT?) = What is he reading?

Guided Walkthrough

Let's trace the logic of a conversation:

A: **你看什么？** (What do you read?)

B: **我看书。** (I read a book.)

A: **你是学生吗？** (Are you a student?)

B: **是，我是学生。** (Yes, I am a student.)

Workbook 5: Interrogation

1. What particle do you add to the end of a sentence to make it a Yes/No question?
2. Translate to English: **你是Khaopan吗？**
3. Translate to English: **他喝水吗？** (*tā hē shuǐ ma?*)
4. What does **什么** (*shén me*) mean?
5. Translate to Chinese: "What do you drink?" (Hint: You drink what?)
6. Translate to Pinyin: **你看什么？**
7. Turn this statement into a question: **我吃苹果。** (Do I eat an apple?)
8. Match: "ma" is used for (A. What, B. Who, C. Yes/No).

Answers:

1. 吗 (ma) | 2. Are you Khaopan? | 3. Does he drink water? | 4. What
5. 你喝什么？ | 6. nǐ kàn shén me? | 7. 我吃苹果吗？ | 8. C (Yes/No)

Lesson 6: Possession (The Magic "的")

The Concept (The "Why")

To show ownership in English, we use "'s" (Khaopan's book) or unique words like "My" or "Your". In Chinese, we use a single, universal linking particle: **的 (*de*)**. It links the owner to the object.

Varied Examples

- **我** (I) + **的** = **我的** (*wǒ de*) - My / Mine
- **你** (You) + **的** = **你的** (*nǐ de*) - Your / Yours
- **Family Nouns:** **爸爸** (*bà ba*) = Dad | **妈妈** (*mā ma*) = Mom

Guided Walkthrough

Combining possession with the "To Be" verb:

This is my dad: **这** (zhè - This) + **是** (is) + **我的** (my) + **爸爸** (dad) = **这是我的爸爸。**

Is this your apple?: **这** (This) + **是** (is) + **你的** (your) + **苹果** (apple) + **吗** (Question flag) = **这是你的苹果吗？**

Workbook 6: Ownership

1. What particle is used to show possession?
2. Translate to English: **我的** (*wǒ de*)
3. Translate to English: **你的妈妈** (*nǐ de mā ma*)
4. Translate to Chinese characters: "My apple"
5. Translate to Pinyin: **我的书** (My book)
6. What does **爸爸** (*bà ba*) mean?
7. Fill in the blank: **他是 ___ 爸爸。** (He is MY dad.)
8. Sentence Scramble: **妈妈 / 的 / 是 / 这 / 我** (This is my mom.)

Answers:

1. 的 (de) | 2. My / Mine | 3. Your mom | 4. 我的苹果
5. wǒ de shū | 6. Dad / Father | 7. 我的 (wǒ de) | 8. 这是我的妈妈。

Phase 3: Radicals & Character Building Blocks

Lesson 7: The Logic of Radicals

The Concept (The "Why")

Chinese characters are not random drawings. They are constructed using smaller building blocks called **Radicals**. Radicals act like meta-data tags; they give you a visual hint about the *meaning* or *category* of the word. Memorizing radicals helps you guess the meaning of words you have never seen before.

Varied Examples

Radical	Meaning	Example Character	Pinyin & Meaning
氵	Water	喝 (hē)	To drink (Needs water!)
亻	Person	你 (nǐ)	You (Refers to a person)
讠	Speech	语 (yǔ)	Language / Speech
木	Wood/Tree	桌 (zhuō)	Table (Made of wood)

Guided Walkthrough

Imagine you see the character 洗 (*xǐ*). Even if you don't know the Pinyin, you see the three drops of water (氵) on the left side. You can deduce that this verb has something to do with water. (It means "To wash"!).

Workbook 7: Radical Recognition

1. What does the radical 氵 represent?
2. If a character has the 讠 radical, what is it likely related to?
3. What is the radical for "Person"?
4. Which of these characters likely means "Sea" or "Ocean"? (A. 林 B. 海 C. 休)
5. Translate *hē* to English.
6. What is the Pinyin for "You"?
7. Translate 语 (*yǔ*) to English.
8. True or False: Radicals help you guess the meaning of a character.

Answers:

1. Water | 2. Speech/Language | 3. 亻 | 4. B (海)
5. To drink | 6. nǐ | 7. Language / Speech | 8. True

Lesson 8: Adding "Where" (Location)

The Concept (The "Why")

In English, we usually put the location at the end of the sentence ("I read a book *at home*"). In Chinese, there is a strict golden rule: **The location where an action happens must come BEFORE the verb.**

You establish the stage before the actors perform. We use the word 在 (***zài***), which means "at / in / on".

Varied Examples

- 家 (*jiā*) = Home
- 学校 (*xué xiào*) = School
- 商店 (*shāng diàn*) = Store / Shop

Guided Walkthrough

Blueprint: Subject + 在 (zài) + Location + Verb + Object

I read a book at home.
Logic: I (at) home read book.

Chinese: **我在家看书。** (*wǒ zài jiā kàn shū.*)

Does he drink water at school?
Logic: He (at) school drink water (ma)?
Chinese: **他在学校喝水吗？** (*tā zài xué xiào hē shuǐ ma?*)

Workbook 8: Location Protocol

1. Does the location come BEFORE or AFTER the verb in Chinese?
2. What word means "at/in/on"?
3. Translate to English: **他在学校。** (*tā zài xué xiào.*)
4. Translate to Pinyin: "Home"
5. Sentence Scramble: **水 / 喝 / 在家 / 我** (Rearrange to "I drink water at home")
6. Translate to Chinese characters: "Store/Shop"
7. Translate to English: **你在学校吃苹果吗？**
8. Fill in the blank: *wǒ ___ xué xiào kàn shū.* (I read at school).

Answers:

1. BEFORE | 2. 在 (zài) | 3. He is at school. | 4. jiā
5. 我在家喝水。 | 6. 商店 (shāng diàn) | 7. Do you eat apples at school? | 8. zài

Phase 4: Everyday & Technical Vocabulary

Lesson 9: The Timeline (Time Words)

The Concept (The "Why")

Following the same logic as locations, Time words also come **BEFORE** the verb. Think of it as painting the background before painting the action. You can place the time either at the very beginning of the sentence or right after the subject.

Varied Examples

- **今天** (*jīn tiān*) = Today
- **明天** (*míng tiān*) = Tomorrow
- **点** (*diǎn*) = O'clock (e.g., 8 O'clock = **八点** bā diǎn)

Guided Walkthrough

Today I drink water.
Logic: Today I drink water.
Chinese: **今天我喝水。** (*jīn tiān wǒ hē shuǐ.*)

I read a book at 8 o'clock.
Logic: I 8 o'clock read book.
Chinese: **我八点看书。** (*wǒ bā diǎn kàn shū.*)

Workbook 9: Time Management

1. Translate to English: **今天** (*jīn tiān*)
2. Translate to Pinyin: Tomorrow
3. How do you say "3 o'clock"? (Use the number 3 + diǎn)
4. Translate to English: **明天我在家。** (*míng tiān wǒ zài jiā.*)
5. Sentence Scramble: **看书 / 我 / 八点** (I read at 8 o'clock)
6. True or False: Time words go at the very end of a Chinese sentence.
7. Translate to Chinese: Today I eat an apple.
8. Match: "diǎn" means (A. Day, B. Tomorrow, C. O'clock).

Answers:

1. Today | 2. míng tiān | 3. 三点 (sān diǎn) | 4. Tomorrow I am at home.
5. 我八点看书。 | 6. False (They go before the verb). | 7. 今天我吃苹果。 | 8. C (O'clock)

Lesson 10: Tech Nouns & Action Verbs

The Concept (The "Why")

Modern Chinese vocabulary is incredibly descriptive and logical, often combining ancient concepts to describe new technology. For example, a computer is literally an "electric brain" and a mobile phone is a "hand machine." Memorizing these literal translations makes them stick instantly!

Varied Examples

Vocabulary	Pinyin	Literal Translation	Meaning
电脑	*diàn nǎo*	Electric Brain	Computer
手机	*shǒu jī*	Hand Machine	Mobile Phone
做	*zuò*	N/A	To do / To make
买	*mǎi*	N/A	To buy

Guided Walkthrough

Let's use the **Master Blueprint: Time + Subject + Location + Verb + Object**

Tomorrow, I buy a computer at the store.
Logic: Tomorrow, I (at) store buy electric-brain.
Chinese: **明天，我在商店买电脑。** (*míng tiān, wǒ zài shāng diàn mǎi diàn nǎo.*)

Workbook 10: Final Compilation

1. What does **电脑** (*diàn nǎo*) literally translate to?
2. Translate to English: **手机** (*shǒu jī*)
3. What is the verb for "to buy"?
4. Translate to English: **我做电脑。** (*wǒ zuò diàn nǎo.*)
5. Sentence Scramble: **买 / 手机 / 他 / 在商店** (He buys a phone at the store)
6. Translate to Pinyin: "To do / To make"
7. Translate to Chinese: Today I am at home.
8. What particle turns **你买手机。** into a question?

Answers:

1. Electric Brain | 2. Mobile Phone | 3. 买 (mǎi) | 4. I make computers.
5. 他在商店买手机。 | 6. zuò | 7. 今天我在家。 | 8. 吗 (ma)

Phase 5: Advanced Beginner Expansion

Lesson 11: The "Counter" Plugin (Measure Words)

The Concept (The "Why")

In English, we can say "one apple" or "two books". In Chinese, you cannot attach a number directly to a noun. You must use a **Measure Word** (also called a classifier) in between them. Think of it as declaring the *data type* of the physical object before you count it. Is it a flat object? A bound object? A cup?

Varied Examples

Formula: Number + Measure Word + Noun

- **个** (*ge*) = Default MW (people, general items). **一个人** (yī ge rén) = One person.
- **本** (*běn*) = Bound items (books). **一本书** (yī běn shū) = One book.
- **杯** (*bēi*) = Cups of liquid. **一杯水** (yī bēi shuǐ) = One cup of water.
- **部** (*bù*) = Electronics, machines. **一部手机** (yī bù shǒu jī) = One phone.

Guided Walkthrough

CRITICAL RULE: When counting "two" of something, Chinese does not use **二** (*èr*). Instead, you must use **两** (***liǎng***).

Wrong: 二个人 (èr ge rén)

Right: **两个人** (liǎng ge rén) = Two people.

Right: **两本书** (liǎng běn shū) = Two books.

Lesson 12: System Error (Negation with 不 and 没)

The Concept (The "Why")

To say a sentence is false, or that an action does not happen, Chinese uses two different words for "not". You must choose the right one based on the context. One is for habits and facts, the other is for ownership and the past.

Varied Examples

- **不 (*bù*):** Use this to negate the verb 是 (to be), habitual actions, or future actions.
  - **我不是学生。** (*wǒ bú shì xué sheng.*) = I am *not* a student.
  - **我不吃苹果。** (*wǒ bù chī píng guǒ.*) = I *do not* eat apples.
- **没 (*méi*):** Use this exclusively to negate the verb 有 (yǒu - to have). You **cannot** ever use 不 with 有.
  - **我没有电脑。** (*wǒ méi yǒu diàn nǎo.*) = I do *not* have a computer.

Lesson 13: The Calendar Module

The Concept (The "Why")

Since you plan schedules, handling dates is essential. The Chinese calendar system completely ignores named months (like January) or days (like Monday). It is 100% numerical and logical.

Varied Examples

- **Months (月 yuè):** Put the number 1 through 12 in front of the word "month".
  - January = **一月** (yī yuè)
  - October = **十月** (shí yuè)
- **Days of the Week (星期 xīng qī):** Put the number 1 through 6 *after* the word "week". Sunday is the exception.
  - Monday = **星期一** (xīng qī yī)
  - Saturday = **星期六** (xīng qī liù)
  - Sunday = **星期天** (xīng qī tiān)

Guided Walkthrough

Today is Monday, October 13th.
Chinese logic: Today is 10-month 13-day Monday.
Chinese: **今天是十月十三号，星期一。** (*jīn tiān shì shí yuè shí sān hào, xīng qī yī.*)
(Note: 号 hào is used for the "day" of the month in spoken Chinese).

Workbook 11: Advanced Beginner Test

1. Fill in the measure word: **两** ___ **书** (Two books)
2. What is the correct word for "two" when counting items?
3. Which negation word do you use with the verb **有** (to have)?
4. Translate: **我不吃苹果。**
5. Fill in the measure word: **四** ___ **水** (Four cups of water)
6. Translate: **星期三** (*xīng qī sān*)
7. Translate: **八月** (*bā yuè*)
8. Translate: **今天星期天。**

Answers:

1. **本** (běn) | 2. **两** (liǎng) | 3. **没** (méi) | 4. I do not eat apples.

5. **杯** (bēi) | 6. Wednesday | 7. August | 8. Today is Sunday.